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Dear Mr. Hellwig,

Working with statistical methods, developing models, and seeing whether they really deliver what they promise is something I truly enjoy. This is why I am applying for the position in credit risk management, where I would like to apply and further develop these methods in the practice of bank management.

For my Master's thesis at the Chair of Statistics and Econometrics, entitled "Tracking Inflation in the G20 at High Frequency and in Real Time: A Machine Learning Approach", I examined how inflation can be nowcast using a large number of predictors. For this purpose, I worked with machine learning approaches and developed an end-to-end forecasting framework using Google Trends data. I automated the data collection, processed and transformed the high-frequency data, and implemented a mixed-frequency forecasting framework, all in Python. I developed and compared machine learning and time series models such as LSTM neural networks and XGBoost. The thesis showed me how important data and quantitative models are for assessing developments and supporting decision-making. At the same time, I was able to deepen my knowledge of data science, statistical modeling, and programming, while learning to approach complex analytical tasks independently and in a structured way.

I have already been able to apply much of this knowledge in practice as a Working Student in the Statistical Methods and Labour Market departments at the Institute for Employment Research (IAB). There, I worked with statistical methods and large datasets: I prepared, validated, and analyzed extensive survey and administrative data, including linked longitudinal data on more than 44,000 respondents, in R and Stata and presented the results in tables and visualizations for researchers. I also supported causal analyses of refugee mobility policies using econometric methods such as propensity score matching, difference-in-differences, and regression kink designs. During my earlier internship at Ziraat Bank, I gained practical insight into retail banking, analyzing customer and portfolio data with SQL and preparing Excel-based analyses for branch management. Through my studies and work experience, I therefore bring a solid foundation in data analysis, model development, and reporting.

In the long term, I am aiming for a career in (quantitative) risk management. I would like to put my analytical skills to use, keep developing professionally, and contribute to developing models and implementing them successfully in practice. I would be very pleased to have a personal conversation with you.

Yours sincerely,
Yigit Coskun